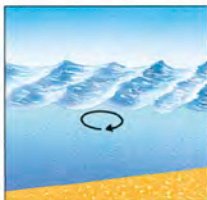




Going . . .

The water inside a wave moves around and around in a circle. It is the wind that drives the wave forward.



Going . . .

Near the shore, the circular shape of the wave is changed and it becomes squashed.



Gone

The top of the wave becomes unstable. When it hits the beach, it topples and spills over.



Surface

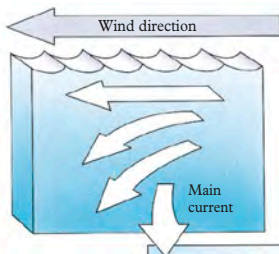
Lighted zone,
up to 660 feet
(200 meters)

Dark zone, up
to 13,000 feet
(4,000 meters)

Deepest zone,
a trench of
36,200 feet
(11,034 meters)

Ocean currents

The direction in which currents move depends on winds and the Earth's spin. Winds blow the top of the oceans forward, but the Earth's spin makes the water below go in a spiral.



The dark depths

Even in clear water, sunlight cannot reach very far. The oceans become darker and darker the farther down you go, until everything turns inky black.

This island is a volcano that has erupted from the ocean floor.

A long, wide ocean ridge

Water, heated by hot rocks, shoots back into the sea.

Molten rock rises up, cools, and forms new seabed.



Frozen worlds

In Antarctica and the Arctic, the oceans freeze. Icebergs break away from glaciers flowing into the water. Only a tiny part of an iceberg is seen above the surface of the ocean.